

ment by subsidising screen repair cost down to ₹13,000 and offering a one time free screen replacement option. Apple on the other hand, charges big for both buying the phone, and fixing its screen.

UPDATE CYCLE

This is an area where Apple's iPhones were unparalleled until very recently. The company delivers the newest updates to its devices for two years, easy, and in the case of iOS 9, it's a year more since the update is smaller in terms of changes. Android, on the other hand, suffers due to the fragmentation it has to face in the industry.

It's an open source system, which allows OEMs to make whatever changes they want to make to their own devices. As a result, Google delivers the update to OEMs, which then work on their own interfaces and then deliver it to the consumers. The Android updates are one of the main reasons why Nexus fans swear by their devices.

On the other hand, companies like Samsung, LG, Sony and Motorola have done pretty well too. The Moto X (2nd Gen) got the Lollipop update before the Nexus phones last year, and that's saying something. It's important to note that even with a near-stock Android interface, Motorola does make changes to the OS in some ways. Greater the changes an OEM makes to the OS, the more work it has to in order to deliver updates.

The LG G3 was another phone that got the Lollipop update pretty quickly, while Sony and Samsung had announced updates for their top-end devices quite fast. Both these companies though, faltered when it came to delivering updates for their lower end smartphones, which irked a lot of users. Such information can be obtained quite easily from sources such as the Digit forums and many others like it online.

Additionally, companies such as Micromax, Intex and others are notorious for not delivering speedy updates on many of their devices. While they've all started picking up the pace, they still lag behind. Custom UIs involve more work for manufacturers while porting updates to their devices. The Chinese manufacturer Xiaomi for example, deals with weekly MiUI updates, while its flagship Xiaomi Mi 4 is still running on Android KitKat here. That's a deal breaker for many of us.

AVAILABILITY OF ACCESSORIES

Last but not the least, the availability of accessories for your smartphone is also quite important. We took to three well known brands for this purpose – Mophie, Otterbox and DailyObjects. The three are well known for making cases and covers for smartphones, and many don't mind spending to get the quality delivered by these companies.

Protecting your device using a well built case can often decide whether your smartphone lasts a year, or two. Pankaj Garg, CEO and Co-Founder of DailyObjects, tells us that Apple and Samsung devices are by far the most popular amongst its buyers. The company also makes both thin and tough cases for iPhones and Samsung's Galaxy devices.

Garg told us that OEMs are chosen entirely according to the consumers' buying habits, and that devices from com-



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panies such as Xiaomi and OnePlus have received much appreciation.

Having third party manufacturers such as DailyObjects, Mophie and OtterBox is a good idea for phone manufacturers. But for some of them also develop cases in-house. So, while flagships from Apple, Samsung and LG get full marks for having accessories made by most of the third parties and in-house as well, Xiaomi, OnePlus and Huawei also get some marks for making them in-house only. The difference though is in the fact that while phones such as the OnePlus One, Xiaomi Mi 4 and some others were

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